

PART 9: SPECIAL ADVENTURES

WATERBORNE ADVENTURES

The sea is an awesome place, the home of terrible monsters, the source of unpredictable currents and strange mists, and the scene of terrible storms that can smash the strongest ship to splinters. Perhaps the most deadly of the sea's hazards, however, is the lack of landmarks. Once out of sight of land, there is little to steer by. A small mistake in navigation or a sudden storm can drive a ship hopelessly off course until a familiar shore is sighted. Only the bravest and most hardy adventurers dare challenge the sea!

Movement on rivers and lakes is handled in a similar manner to sea travel (including encounters and combat). The DM can add any restrictions as to vessel size, slower speed due to winding rivers, etc. as the circumstances dictate. Current may increase (or

decrease if heading upstream) distance travelled by $7-12 (1d6 + 6)$ miles per day. Special hazards such as sand bars, rapids, waterfalls, and monsters can make river and lake travel almost as risky as ocean travel!

SHIPS

In general, galleys are used for travel along the coast. River boats and rafts are used for travel on rivers and will almost surely be destroyed if they venture too far from shore. Below are given the average movement rates in miles travelled per day for the different types of crafts. Where two rates are given, the first is for rowing movement and the second is for sailing. Rowing during an encounter is much faster than when used for long voyages.

Ship	Miles/Day	Feet/Round	Crew			Hull Points	Armor Class	Cargo (cn)
			Rowers	Sailors	Marines			
Canoe	18	60'	—	—	—	5-10	9	6,000
Galley, Large	18/72	90'/120'	180	20	50	100-120	7	40,000
Galley, Small	18/90	90'/150'	60	10	20	80-100	8	20,000
Galley, War	12/72	60'/120'	300	30	75	120-150	7	60,000
Lifeboat, Ship's	18	30'	—	—	—	10-20	9	15,000
Longship	18/90	90'/150'	—	75*	—	60-80	8	40,000
Raft	12	30'	—	—	—	5 per 10' x 10' section	9	50 cn/sq. ft.
River Boat	36	60'	8	2	—	20-40	8	30,000
Sailing Boat	72	120'	—	1	—	20-40	8	20,000
Sailing Ship, Large	72	120'	—	20	50**	120-180	7	300,000
Sailing Ship, Small	90	150'	—	10	25**	60-90	8	100,000

*These also act as rowers and marines.

**Warships only; costs an additional $\frac{1}{3}$ of original.

Hull Points. A ship's ability to remain afloat after taking in water or sustaining damage is given in a value called *hull points*. Hull points for a ship are very similar to hit points for a character; when a ship reaches zero or less hull points, it will sink in 1-10 rounds. Also, when a ship is reduced to zero or less hull points, it may no longer move under its own power or attack with ship-mounted weapons (catapult, etc.), although crew may use personal weapons normally.

Ship Modifications. Some ships can be modified for transport or combat. The costs and effects of these are listed below:

Adding a Ram — Large and Small galleys can add a ram for an additional $\frac{1}{3}$ of the original ship's cost. War Galleys already have a ram (included in their cost).

Troop Transport — Large and Small sailing ships can be converted into troop transports by paying an additional $\frac{1}{3}$ of the original ship's cost. Troop transports have $\frac{1}{3}$ more hull points than normal sailing ships, and carry twice as many troops (marines) as the normal vessel.

Catapult — Longships, any type of galley, and either type of sailed warship can add one light catapult (combat with these will be discussed later). Ordinary sailing ships, troop transports, and the smaller vessels not mentioned above **cannot** mount a catapult. A catapult and 20 rounds of shot weigh 10,000 coins.

WEATHER

As stated before, the miles per day given above represents average sailing conditions. If the voyage is favored by steady winds and calm waters, the distance travelled might be as much as double what is given here. If the seas are rough, or the vessel is becalmed, little or no progress might be made in a day. See the optional **Water Movement Modification Chart** section for more details.

In general, galleys stay near the coast, as they are not considered safe on the high seas. Likewise, river boats, rafts, and sailing boats will almost surely be destroyed if they venture too far onto great bodies of water; all rules for galleys apply to them as well.

If the optional **Water Movement Modification Chart** is not used, the following simple rules should apply. When sailing on seas or oceans, there is a chance that the weather will be unsuitable for travel. Two six-sided dice are rolled at the beginning of the day with a roll of 2 indicating no wind and a roll of 12 meaning gales or fierce storms. Sailing ships (not vessels with rowers) may not move if becalmed and must spend the entire day in the same hex or square. Rowed ships are never stopped for lack of wind; they are unaffected by calm weather. If a gale or storm is indicated, sailed ships may attempt to run before it. This will result in the ship moving at 3 times its normal movement rate in a random direction. If no coastline is reached during this movement, the ship has successfully run before the storm and is safe. If, however, the ship should reach a coastline or other shore before reaching the end of its movement, there is a 75% chance that the ship will be broken up in trying to beach, otherwise it will have found shelter. Galleys may not run before a storm. They have only a 20% chance of being able to weather any gale, with failure resulting in the ship being swamped. However, if the galley is in sight of the coastline, there is a chance that it will be able to beach before the storm hits. If the coastline is clear terrain, the galley will automatically find a beach. For any other type of terrain, roll a six-sided die with a result of 1-2 indicating that a safe beach or cove has been found.

It is assumed that all characters know how to swim, unless some circumstance might prevent this knowledge from being acquired. Swimming movement is equal to one-half the distance that character may normally travel. Characters in any type of metal armor may not swim, instead they will sink and drown.